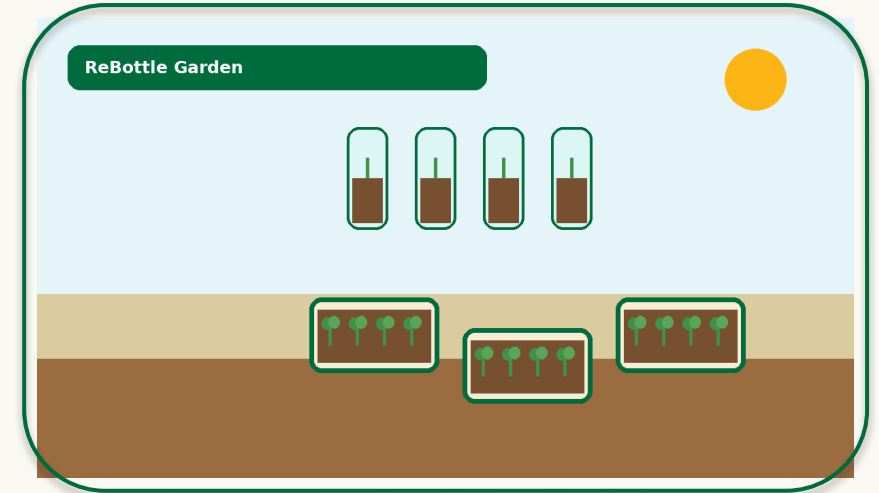


ReBottle Garden

Growing Through Reuse

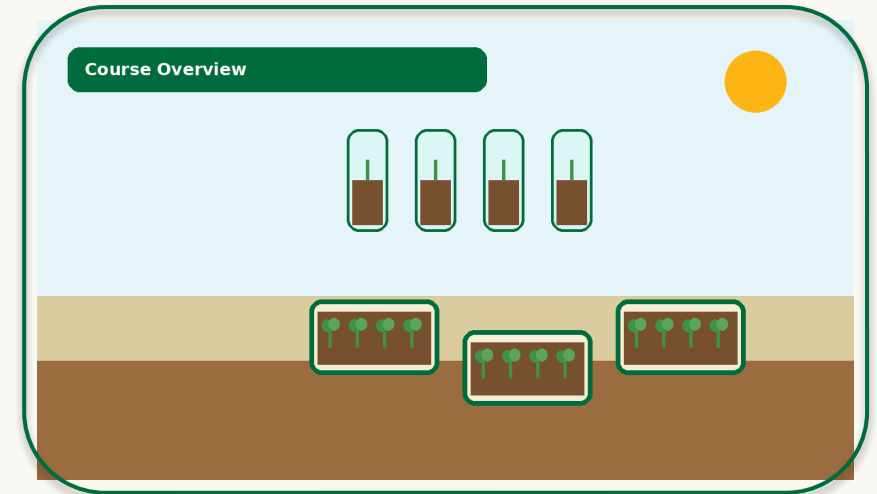
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Nursery Teacher Training
- Audience: Nursery teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 2 hours 30 minutes online + 60 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and completion requirements

- By the end of the course, teachers should be able to explain the garden's learning purpose, prepare age-appropriate activities, facilitate the ten course topics, manage children safely outdoors, and document learning through observation.
- Recommended materials: teacher guide; picture/word cards appropriate to the garden; child-safe tools where needed; watering equipment; observation sheets; drawing materials; labels; handwashing supplies; first-aid access.
- Completion: review all modules, complete the practical teacher task, and demonstrate safe supervision of one short garden lesson.



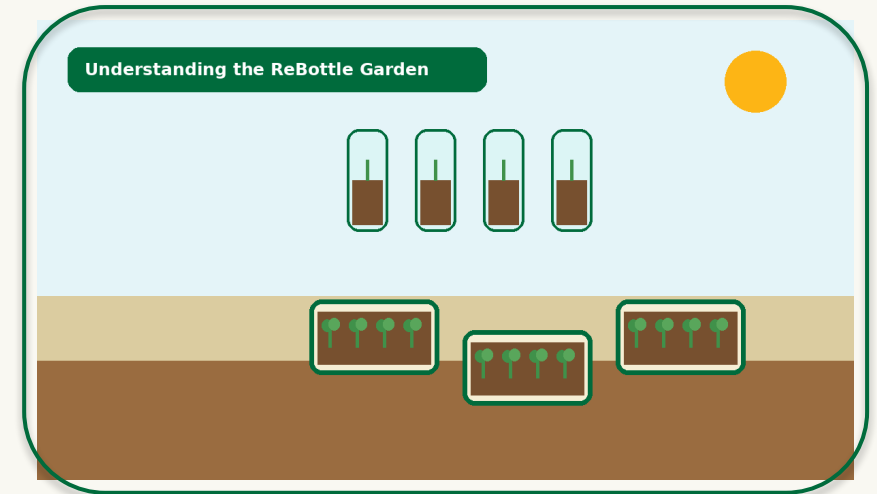
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training principle: concrete experience first, simple language second, repetition throughout.

Understanding the ReBottle Garden

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- A ReBottle Garden uses safely prepared reusable containers as planters within a professionally supported growing system.
- The learning focus is reuse, plant care and responsible use of materials—not collecting litter.
- Only clean, suitable containers prepared by adults should enter the learning area.
- Structures must be stable, smooth-edged and securely mounted.
- Teacher routine: REUSE SAFELY → PLANT → WATER → OBSERVE → MAINTAIN.



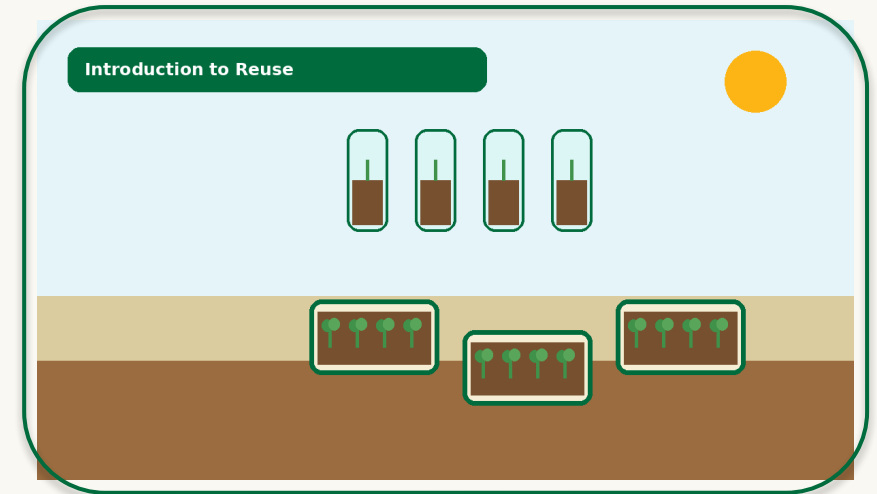
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Inspect the installed ReBottle system before use.

Introduction to Reuse

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Explain reuse as using an item again for a useful purpose instead of immediately discarding it.
- Use simple examples familiar to children.
- Distinguish reuse from playing with dirty waste.
- Connect the bottle planter to responsible use of resources.
- Avoid implying that all plastic items are safe or suitable for garden reuse.



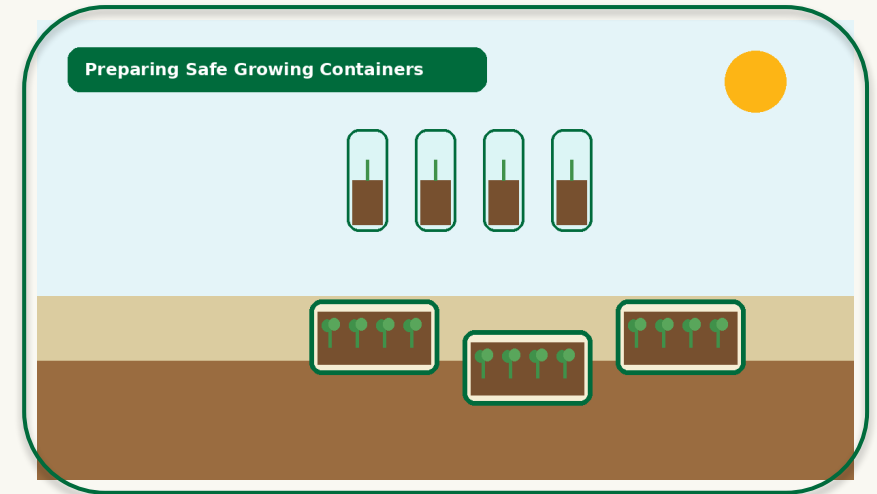
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare one clean example and one picture of the finished planter.

Preparing Safe Growing Containers

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Container cutting, drilling and edge finishing are adult-only preparation tasks.
- Use only containers approved by the garden program; never use containers that held hazardous substances.
- Wash and dry containers before installation.
- Provide drainage holes and secure mounting appropriate to the design.
- Inspect for cracks, sharp edges, loose fasteners and degraded plastic.



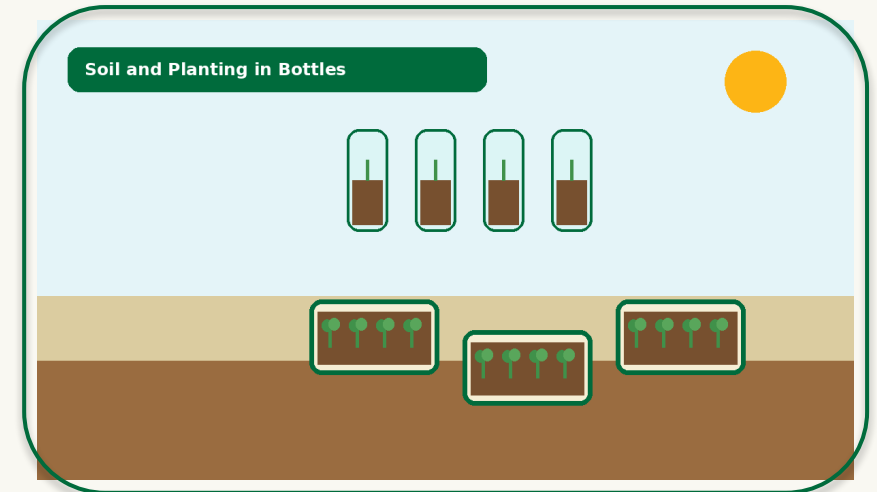
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teacher check: CLEAN • SMOOTH • DRAINING • SECURE • SUITABLE.

Soil and Planting in Bottles

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use clean, appropriate growing media prepared for container crops.
- Fill containers without compacting excessively.
- Demonstrate a small planting hole and gentle seedling placement.
- Keep soil below the rim to reduce spills.
- Use labels or picture markers without sharp stakes at child level.



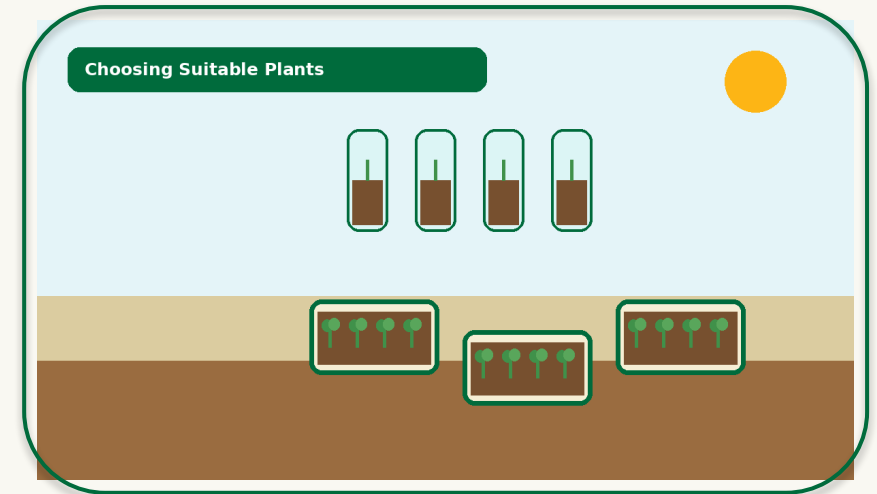
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare filled demonstration containers before pupils arrive.

Choosing Suitable Plants

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Choose compact, shallow-rooted crops appropriate to the container size and local conditions.
- Herbs and selected leafy vegetables are often easier than large, heavy crops.
- Match sunlight needs to wall position.
- Avoid thorny, toxic or highly irritating plants in Nursery areas.
- Use the garden program's approved crop list.



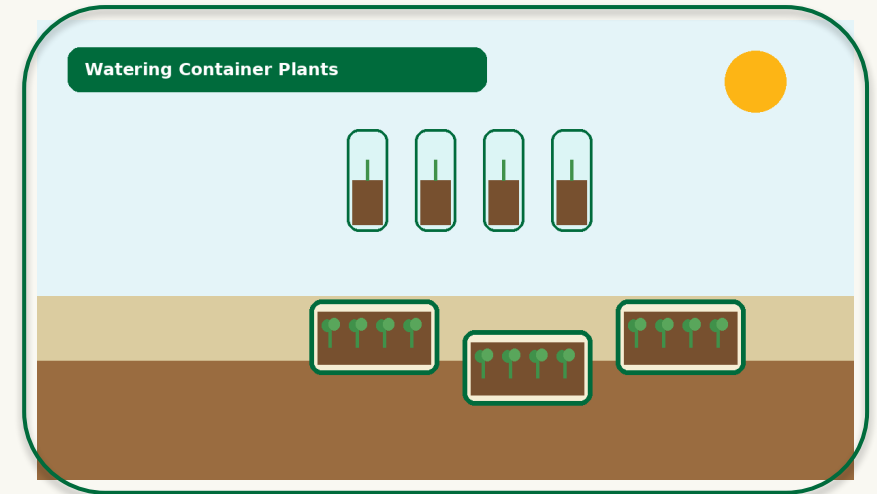
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Select 2–3 crops suited to the installed containers.

Watering Container Plants

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Container plants may dry faster than ground beds, so check moisture regularly.
- Use small watering cans or a controlled irrigation system.
- Water the growing medium rather than splashing children or walls.
- Ensure excess water drains safely and does not create slippery surfaces.
- Teach children that more water is not always better.



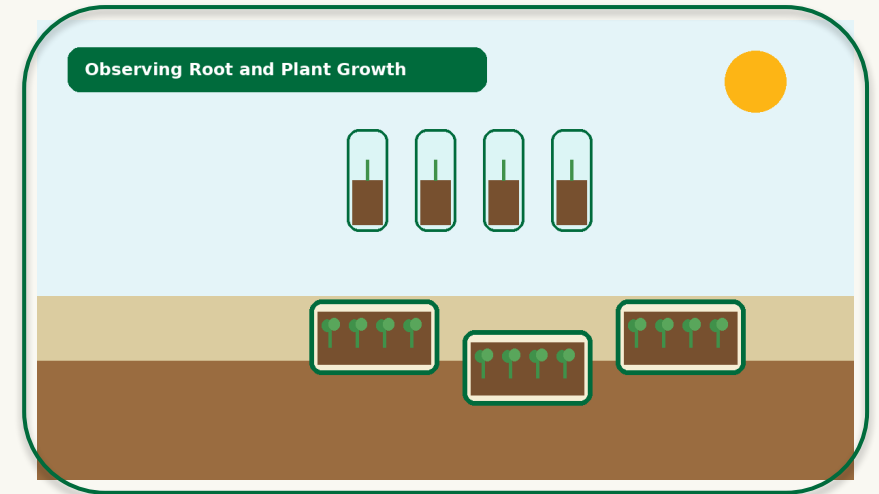
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Demonstrate "small amount, check, then add if needed."

Observing Root and Plant Growth

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Where a safe transparent observation section exists, point out visible roots without exposing them.
- Observe new leaves, plant height and changes over time.
- Use photographs or drawings to compare earlier and later growth.
- Do not pull plants out simply to inspect roots.
- Connect growth observations to water, light and care.



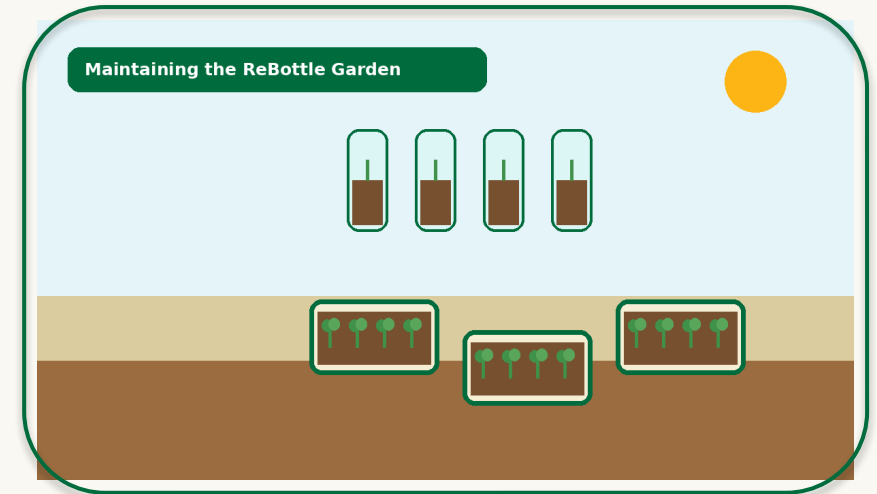
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Set a weekly observation point for one selected plant.

Maintaining the ReBottle Garden

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Check mounting frames, containers, drainage and irrigation routinely.
- Replace damaged containers promptly.
- Remove dead plant material and manage weeds carefully.
- Refresh growing media when needed under program guidance.
- Keep the wall tidy and accessible for observation.
- Record recurring problems such as drying, blocked drainage or loose units.



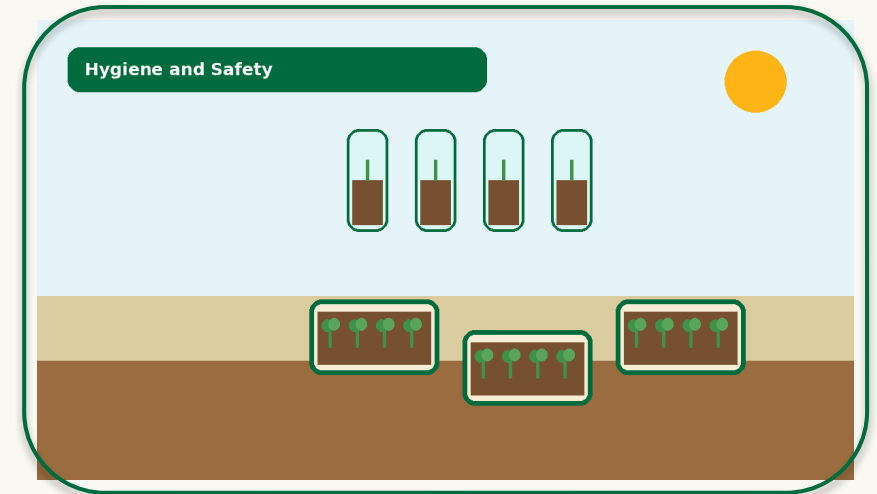
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Use a simple weekly maintenance checklist.

Hygiene and Safety

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Adults handle cutting, drilling, repairs and structural adjustments.
- Children use only finished, secure planters.
- Prevent standing water that can attract mosquitoes or create hygiene problems.
- Wash hands after handling soil and plants.
- Keep walkways dry and clear.
- Follow school procedures for tools, allergies, heat and first aid.



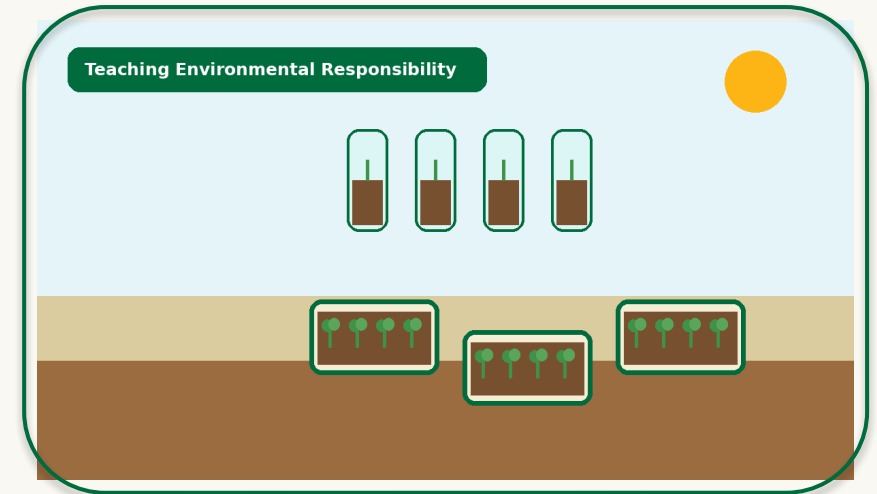
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Inspect every planter at child height before the lesson.

Teaching Environmental Responsibility

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use the garden to discuss careful use of materials, keeping surroundings clean and making useful choices.
- Avoid guilt-based messages; focus on practical responsibility.
- Ask children what can be reused safely and what should go through proper waste systems.
- Connect reuse with caring for plants and the school environment.
- Celebrate maintenance and responsible behavior, not just the finished structure.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: design a reuse-and-growing activity for Nursery learners.